

# Stakeholders

# Stakeholders

- **Overview on Stakeholders**
- **Stakeholders Management Process**
  - Identify
  - Analyse
  - Prioritize
  - Engage
  - Communicate
  - Manage Expectations
  - Scale

# Stakeholders overview

Stakeholders are individuals or groups with an interest in the project's success. They can influence or be affected by the project's outcomes.

### **Stakeholder Personas:**

- **Definition:** A persona is a "mockup" of a stakeholder group that captures typical needs, motivations, values, and behaviors.
- **Purpose:** Helps in understanding and engaging stakeholders by providing a realistic profile that informs engagement strategies.
- **Application:** Useful for developing targeted communication, predicting stakeholder responses, and designing solutions aligned with their needs.
- **Example:** For an online retailer, customer personas might include demographics, purchase behaviors, pain points, and preferred communication channels.

# Stakeholders Management Process

- A complex area navigating
  - **Priorities** : Different stakeholders often have varying priorities regarding the project.
  - **Organizational politics** : Stakeholder management often involves dealing with internal politics, as stakeholders come from various departments, teams, or levels within an organization.
  - **Conflicting visions** : Stakeholders might have different or even conflicting visions of what the project should achieve.
- Human relationships : Building and maintaining positive relationships is the foundation of effective stakeholder management. This involves empathy, active listening, and transparent communication.

# Stakeholders Management Process

- Stakeholder management process
  - Identify
  - Analyse
  - Prioritise
  - Engage
  - Communicate
  - Manage Expectations

# Identifying stakeholders

# Stakeholders

- Stakeholders are the people who
  - Have an interest in a product, team or project
  - Can influence the product, team or project
- Common Agile stakeholders are
  - Users
  - Investors
  - Customers
  - Product owners
  - Project managers
  - CxOs

# Stakeholder types

- There are different ways to understand how a stakeholder fits into the project
- Primary stakeholders: Have a direct stake in the organization and its success
- Secondary stakeholders: Have a public or special interest stake in the organisation
- Core stakeholders: Essential to the success of the company
- Strategic stakeholders: Vital to the organisation and the threats and opportunities it faces
- Environmental stakeholders: Other people in the organisation's environment

# Stakeholder roles

- Likewise, there are different ways to understand the role they will play
  - Influencers
  - Contributors
  - Reviewers
  - Approvers
- Important to associate stakeholders with these roles to facilitate analysis

# Identifying stakeholders - Questions

- Consider who has the ability to
  - Impact your project
  - Enhance your project
  - Slow down your projects
  - Remove impediments
  - Lead opinions
  - Facilitate the resulting product
  - Provide a voice of reason
- External influencers
  - Contractors, Competitors, Regulators, etc.
- Those who have to live with the product

# Identifying stakeholders - Techniques

- This is like any other knowledge discovery process
- Can be informed by the questions above and considering
  - Existing business structures
  - Existing documents relating to the business area
  - Interviewing obvious stakeholders to uncover those who are less obvious
  - Looking to the competition...
  - Clients will often know most of the stakeholders on their side

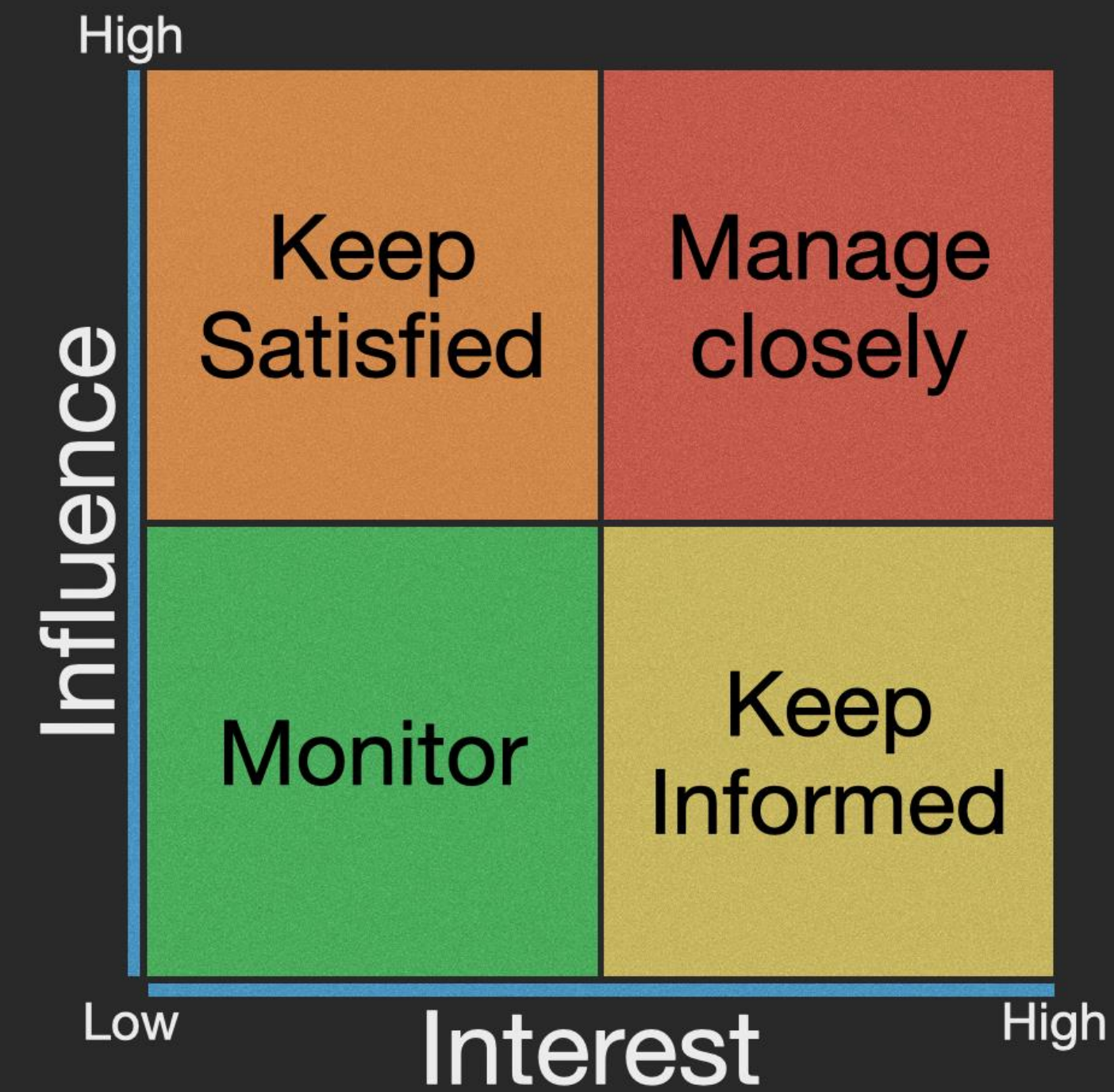
# Analysing stakeholders

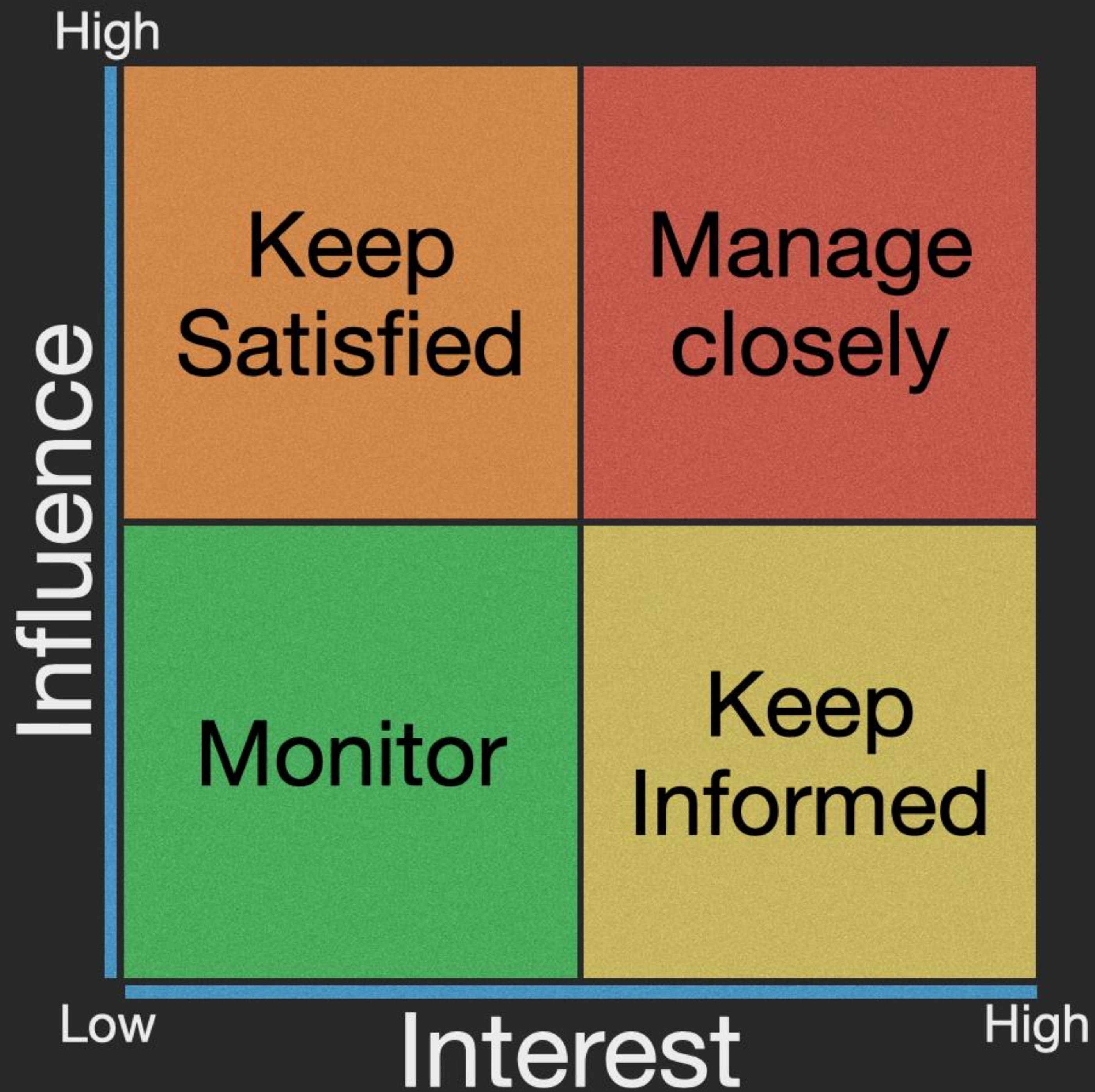
# Analysing stakeholders

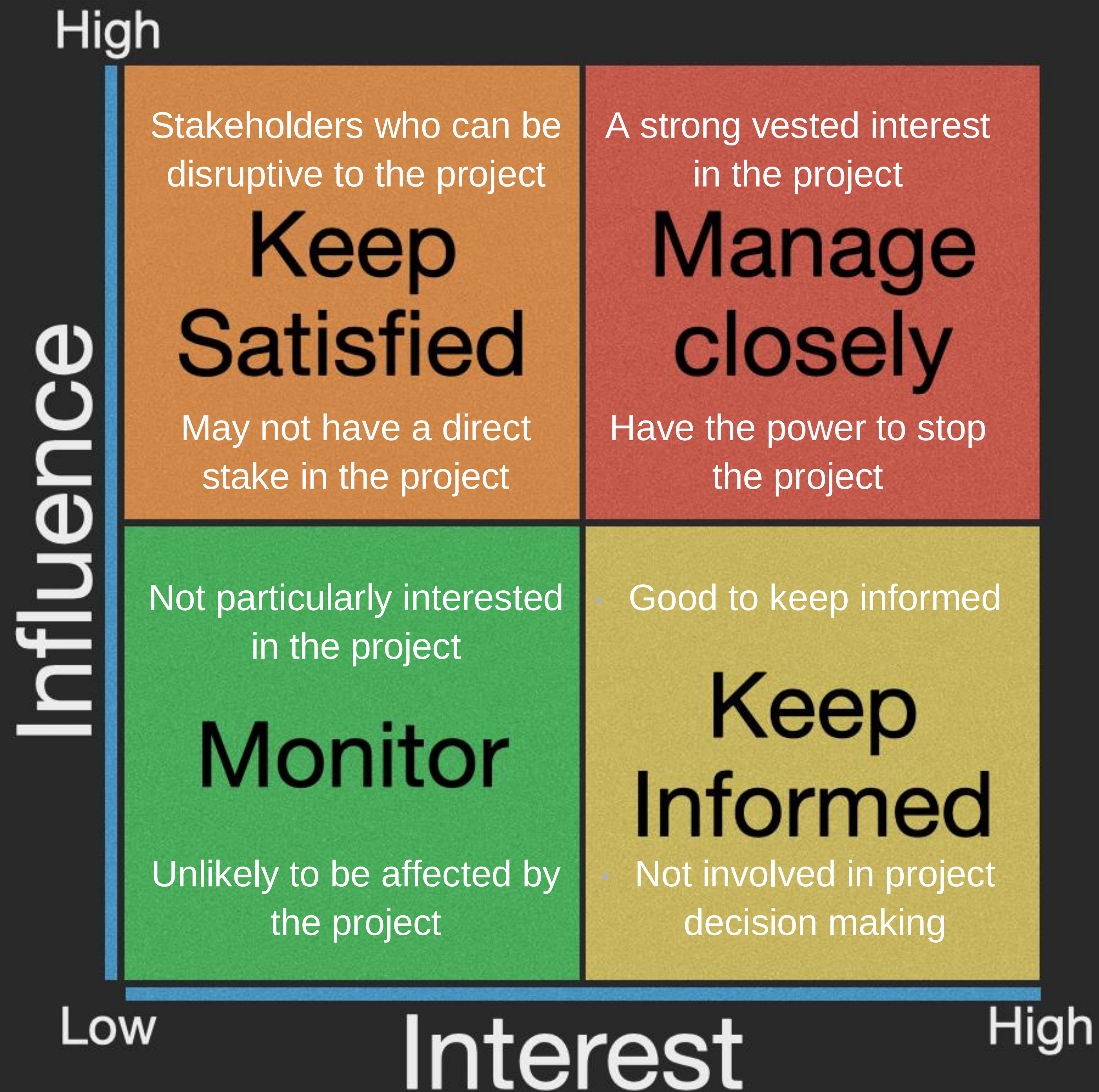
- Once identified stakeholders need to be analysed
- Allows stakeholders and their potential impact on the project to be better understood
- Models how different stakeholders have different degrees of influence and interest
  - Some will hold more power than others
  - Some will have more interest than others
  - Some will have lots of both, and others little of either
- A stakeholder map is a common tool used for this purpose
  - Stakeholder map should be produced early in a project, and reviewed throughout

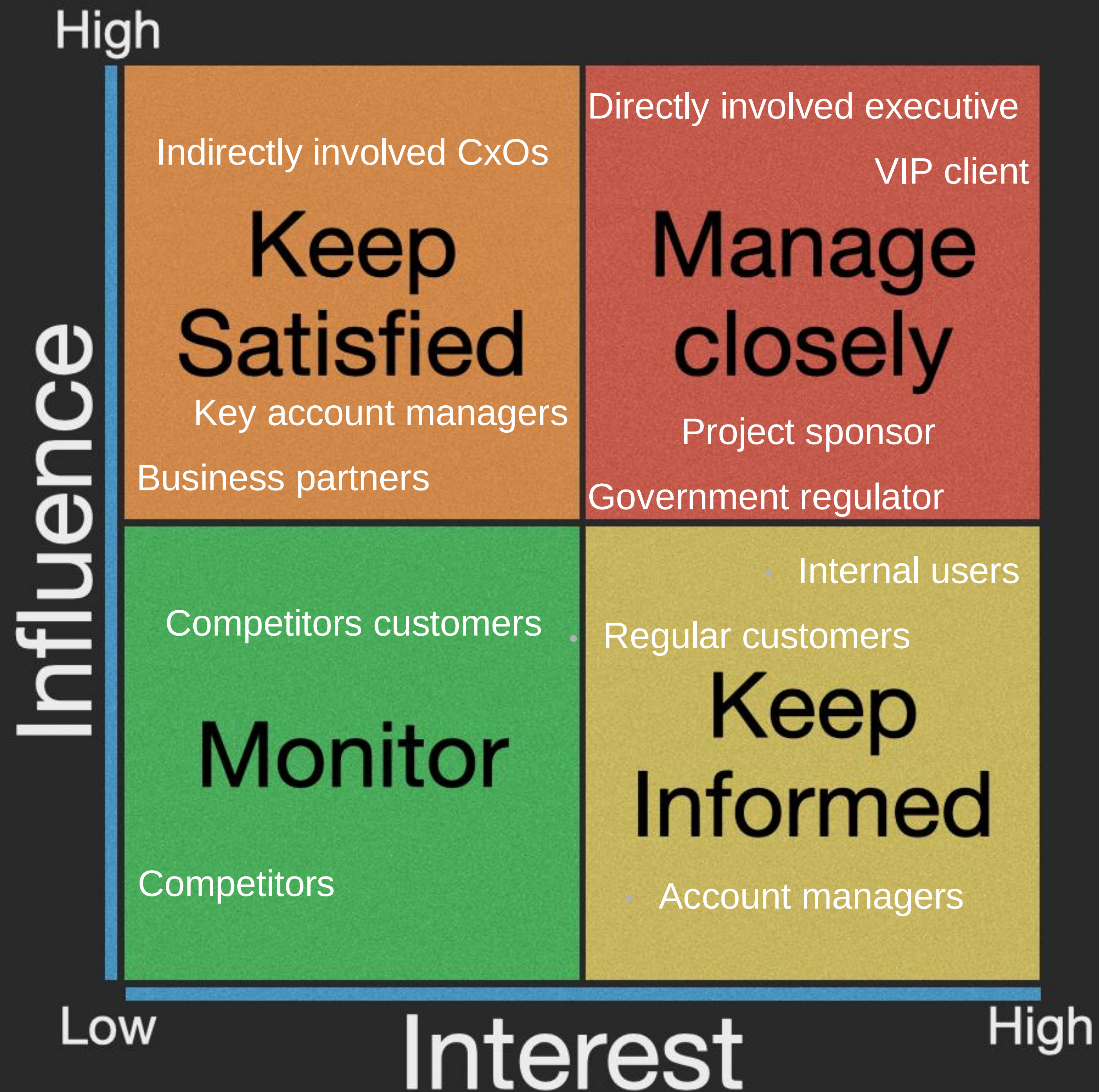
# Stakeholder Map

- Sometimes referred to as an Influence/Interest matrix
- A simple matrix used to categorise the stakeholders in a project
- Typically maps stakeholders in terms of **Influence** and **Interest**
  - **Influence**: a stakeholders ability to influence project strategy or resources
  - **Interest**: how interested a stakeholder is in the project succeeding









# Stakeholder map use

- Stakeholder map can help
  - Understand who the stakeholders are
  - Determine their value within a project
  - Identify stakeholder relationships to the project
  - Inform stakeholder prioritisation
  - Inform the best strategy to take when dealing with each stakeholder
- Note, the dimensions can be changed to map other factors
  - Power/Interest, Knowledge/Attitude, Power/Predictability
- However, Stakeholder maps are high-level and reductive, requiring supplementary detail

# Prioritising stakeholders

# Prioritising stakeholders - Process

- Similar process to grooming a backlog
  - Continuous process
  - Can use similar approaches to other prioritisation tasks
  - Informed by what you have learned from stakeholder analysis

# Prioritising stakeholders - Factors

- Consider factors such as:
  - Influence, not just prominence
  - Interest
  - Availability
  - Attitude
- Also factor in when a stakeholder is of most value
  - for example, during a particular sprint

# Engaging stakeholders

# Engaging stakeholders

- Need to continuously engage with the stakeholders
  - Taking prioritisation into consideration
  - Sensitive to the point in the project we are at
- Need to define how to interact with stakeholders
- Determine the touch-points when interaction will happen
  - This will be different for different stakeholders
  - e.g. individual communication, Agile ceremony such as Sprint Review, etc.
- Define the frequency of engagement
- Define the objectives of any engagement in advance
- Review how the engagement went and learn from it
- This is a complex area that needs modelled and tracked

# RACI matrix

- Stands for **Responsible**, **Accountable**, **Consulted** and **Informed**
- A matrix that highlights the state of responsibility a stakeholder has regarding a task
- Stakeholder states of responsibility and task status can be tracked using the matrix
- The states can vary depending on the version used, e.g. RASCI, and Support as a state
- States commonly found include:
  - **Responsible**: directly responsible for successfully completing a task
  - **Accountable**: final authority over the successful completion of a task or deliverable
  - **Consulted**: insights the team can consult
  - **Informed**: not directly involved but you should kept informed

# RACI assignment matrix

| Project Thingy | Amy Adams   | Bob Brown   | Cindy Clark | Dave Davis  | Status |
|----------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|-------------|--------|
| Task T1        | Responsible | Accountable | Consulted   | Informed    | Done   |
| Task T2        | Accountable | Consulted   | Informed    | Responsible | Done   |
| Task T3        | Consulted   | Informed    | Responsible | Accountable | Stuck  |
| Task T4        | Accountable | Consulted   | Informed    | Responsible | Doing  |
| ...            | ...         | ...         | ...         | ...         | ...    |

# RACI guidelines

- Only one person is accountable per task, deliverable or activity
  - Otherwise there is no clear line of authority
- Only one responsibility type per person per task
  - Otherwise the matrix get becomes confusing, rather than helpful
- Accountable person needs the authority to finish the task
  - Otherwise they are not actually the accountable person
- Only the responsible and accountable roles are mandatory for every task
  - Not every task is complex enough to need outside input
- Prioritise effective communication
  - The matrix helps but this is a cultural challenge
- Keep all stakeholders informed at all times
  - From top to bottom

# Value of RACI

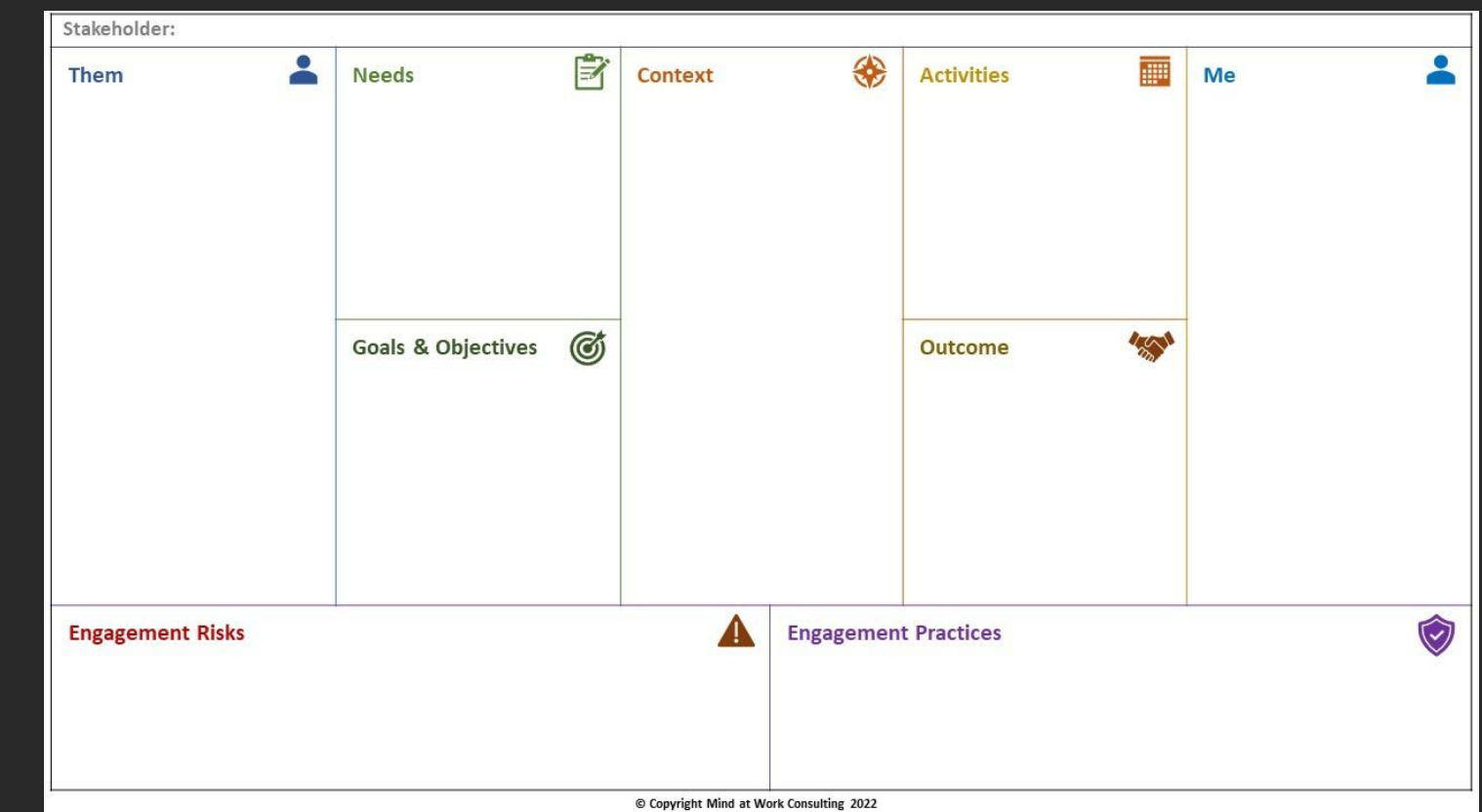
- RACI helps to visualise responsibilities but it is not a work breakdown tool
- Work breakdown needs to be done before mapping states of responsibility
- RACI is useful for
  - Large or complex organisations, teams or projects
  - Projects involving a wide range of stakeholders
  - Organisations with well defined roles
  - Projects in regulated industries
- RACI is less useful for
  - Small projects or teams
  - Lets you know who to engage with but not much else
  - Agile Scrum

# So what about Agile Scrum?

- Agile teams, and organisations, are cross functional collaborative and self-organising
- Responsibility is expected to be taken more than given
- As such, RACI could just remove agility
- Some tools commonly used in Agile Scrum help to map and track responsibility
  - For example, Kanban boards help although do not fully replicate the value of RACI
  - Stakeholder Engagement Canvas is another useful tool

# Stakeholder Engagement Canvas

- Helps to explore a holistic view of the stakeholders
- Encourages emotionally intelligent, user centred, engagement
- Ideally used for one stakeholder at a time
- However, can be used for a group or category of stakeholder
- The canvas categories cover
  - **Them**: Who are the stakeholders and what is their world like?
  - **Needs**: What are their requirements?
  - **Goals & Objectives**: What are the goals of this project?
  - **Context**: What is the nature of the work we will do together?
  - **Activities**: What interactions will we have?
  - **Outcome**: What is the expected outcome of this engagement?
  - **Me**: What perceptions do I have about this stakeholder?
  - **Engagement Risks**: What potential problems could happen during this engagement?
  - **Engagement Practice**: What practices will I employ to mitigate the engagement risks?



Stakeholder:

|      |                                                                                  |                    |                                                                                     |         |                                                                                    |            |                                                                                     |    |                                                                                    |
|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Them |  | Needs              |   | Context |  | Activities |   | Me |  |
|      |                                                                                  | Goals & Objectives |  |         |                                                                                    | Outcome    |  |    |                                                                                    |

|                  |                                                                                       |                      |                                                                                       |
|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Engagement Risks |  | Engagement Practices |  |
|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |                                               |                                |                                             |                           |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|---------------------------|
| Stakeholder:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                       |                                               |                                |                                             |                           |
| <div>Them</div> <div><ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Who are they?</li><li>• What is their role?</li><li>• What's their background?</li><li>• What's their attitude to work?</li><li>• What do they see and hear around them?</li><li>• Who do they work with, and in what way?</li><li>• What's happening in their world?</li></ul></div> | <div>Needs</div> <div></div>                  | <div>Context</div> <div></div> | <div>Activities</div> <div></div>           | <div>Me</div> <div></div> |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | <div>Goals &amp; Objectives</div> <div></div> |                                | <div>Outcome</div> <div></div>              |                           |
| <div>Engagement Risks</div> <div></div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |                                               |                                | <div>Engagement Practices</div> <div></div> |                           |

| Stakeholder:                                                                                           |                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                            |                                                                                                         |                                                                                       |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Them                                                                                                   |  | <div>Needs</div> <div><ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• What are their requirements?</li><li>• Are there alternatives?</li><li>• What are the issues or problems they face?</li><li>• What would a perfect solution look like to them?</li><li>• What frustrates them?</li><li>• What delights them?</li><li>• What do they need from me throughout this engagement?</li></ul></div> | Context                  | <div>Activities</div> | Me  |
|                                                                                                        |                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                            | <div>Outcome</div>   |                                                                                       |
| Engagement Risks  |                                                                                  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Engagement Practices  |                                                                                                         |                                                                                       |

|                             |                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                  |
|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Them                        | <div></div> | <div>Needs<div></div></div>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | <div>Context<div></div></div> | <div>Activities<div></div></div>              | Me <div></div> |
|                             |                                                                                             | <div>Goals &amp; Objectives<div></div><div><ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• What do they want to achieve; short/long term?</li><li>• What is valuable to them?</li><li>• What do they need from this project?</li><li>• How will it be measured?</li><li>• What would happen if we miss the objectives?</li><li>• How can we track progress?</li><li>• What's in it for them?</li></ul></div></div> |                                                                                                                 | <div>Outcome<div></div></div>                |                                                                                                  |
| <div>Engagement Risks</div> |                                                                                             |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <div></div>                | <div>Engagement Practices<div></div></div> |                                                                                                  |

|                  |                                                                                  |                    |                                                                                       |                                                                                       |                                                                                     |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Stakeholder:     |                                                                                  |                    |                                                                                       |                                                                                       |                                                                                     |
| Them             |  | Needs              |     | Context                                                                               |   |
|                  |                                                                                  | Goals & Objectives |    |                                                                                       |                                                                                     |
|                  |                                                                                  |                    |                                                                                       | Activities                                                                            |   |
|                  |                                                                                  |                    |                                                                                       | Outcome                                                                               |  |
|                  |                                                                                  |                    |                                                                                       |                                                                                       | Me                                                                                  |
|                  |                                                                                  |                    |                                                                                       |                                                                                       |   |
| Engagement Risks |                                                                                  |                    |  | Engagement Practices                                                                  |                                                                                     |
|                  |                                                                                  |                    |                                                                                       |  |                                                                                     |

- What is the nature of the work?
- What is their area of expertise?
- What type of information will they provide?
- What decision-making authority do they have?
- Is there previous history?
- What is the scope of work?

|                  |                                                                                  |                    |         |                                                                                       |                                                                                     |                                                                                    |    |                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|---------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Stakeholder:     |                                                                                  |                    |         |                                                                                       |                                                                                     |                                                                                    |    |                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
| Them             |  | Needs              | Context |     | Activities                                                                          |  | Me |  |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|                  |                                                                                  | Goals & Objectives |         |                                                                                       |  |                                                                                    |    |                                                                                    | <div><ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• What types of interactions will we have?</li><li>• When and how frequently?</li><li>• What workshops will they attend and their expected contribution?</li><li>• What interviews or other discussions will we have?</li><li>• Who else will be involved in our interactions?</li><li>• How much time are we expecting from this stakeholder?</li></ul></div> |
| Engagement Risks |                                                                                  |                    |         |  | Engagement Practices                                                                |                                                                                    |    |                                                                                    |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |

| Stakeholder:     |                                                                                  |                    |                                                                                    |                                                                                       |                                                                                    |                                                                                       |                                                                                    |    |                                                                                    |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Them             |  | Needs              |  | Context                                                                               |  | Activities                                                                            |  | Me |  |
|                  |                                                                                  | Goals & Objectives |                                                                                    |    |                                                                                    | Outcome                                                                               |                                                                                    |    |                                                                                    |
|                  |                                                                                  |                    |                                                                                    |                                                                                       |                                                                                    |                                                                                       |                                                                                    |    |                                                                                    |
|                  |                                                                                  |                    |                                                                                    |                                                                                       |                                                                                    |                                                                                       |                                                                                    |    |                                                                                    |
|                  |                                                                                  |                    |                                                                                    |                                                                                       |                                                                                    |                                                                                       |                                                                                    |    |                                                                                    |
| Engagement Risks |                                                                                  |                    |                                                                                    |  | Engagement Plan                                                                    |  |                                                                                    |    |                                                                                    |

- What results are they expecting?
- What outputs do they need from me?
- What artifacts do they need?
- What level of formality is needed?
- How will we keep them up to date with progress?
- How will we maintain transparency?

Stakeholder:

|                  |                                                                                  |                    |                                                                                     |         |                                                                                       |                      |                                                                                     |    |                                                                                    |                                                                                       |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Them             |  | Needs              |   | Context |     | Activities           |   | Me |  |                                                                                       |
|                  |                                                                                  | Goals & Objectives |  |         |                                                                                       | Outcome              |  |    |                                                                                    |                                                                                       |
| Engagement Risks |                                                                                  |                    |                                                                                     |         |  | Engagement Practices |                                                                                     |    |                                                                                    |  |

- Do I have any preconceived notions about the stakeholder?
- What perceptions do I have about them?
- Is there history that may influence how I see or feel about them?
- What opinions do I have of them, true or false?
- What attitude do I have towards them?
- What thoughts do I have about them?

|      |                                                                                  |                    |         |                                                                                    |            |    |                                                                                    |
|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|---------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------|----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Them |  | Needs              | Context |  | Activities | Me |  |
|      |                                                                                  | Goals & Objectives |         |                                                                                    |            |    |                                                                                    |

- What potential problems could happen between me and this stakeholder?
- Are there areas of conflict?
- What misunderstandings could occur?
- Is there something that could jeopardize the engagement?
- Could there be communication issues?
- What else may affect the engagement?

|                  |                                                                                       |                      |                                                                                       |
|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Engagement Risks |  | Engagement Practices |  |
|------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|

Stakeholder:

|                  |                                                                                  |                    |                                                                                     |         |                                                                                       |                      |                                                                                     |    |                                                                                    |                                                                                       |
|------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Them             |  | Needs              |   | Context |     | Activities           |   | Me |  |                                                                                       |
|                  |                                                                                  | Goals & Objectives |  |         |                                                                                       | Outcome              |  |    |                                                                                    |                                                                                       |
| Engagement Risks |                                                                                  |                    |                                                                                     |         |  | Engagement Practices |                                                                                     |    |                                                                                    |  |

- What tools and techniques will I use?
- How will I communicate and build rapport with the stakeholder?
- What approach will work best with the stakeholder?
- How will I mitigate engagement risks?
- What preparations must I complete?
- How will I remain mindful throughout the engagement?

|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |                                                                                                        |                                                                                          |                                                                                                            |                                                                                               |                                                                                       |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Stakeholder:                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 |                                                                                                        |                                                                                          |                                                                                                            |                                                                                               |                                                                                       |
| Them                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |                        | Needs  | Context                  | Activities  | Me  |
| <div>“With all the elements explored and considered, now we can put together an action plan that will ensure we can effectively work with our stakeholder and employ the right techniques to build rapport, trust and engagement.”<br/><a href="#">Berkidge (2022)</a></div> |                                                                                                        |                                                                                          |                                                                                                            |                                                                                               |                                                                                       |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | Goals & Objectives  |                                                                                          |                                                                                                            | Outcome    |                                                                                       |
| Engagement Risks                                                                                                                                                                        |                                                                                                        |                                                                                          | Engagement Practices  |                                                                                               |                                                                                       |

# Communicating with stakeholders

# Communicating with stakeholders - Rights

- The Stakeholder Engagement canvas provides detailed stakeholder understanding
- This is critical in communicating with stakeholders on an ongoing basis
- Stakeholders have the right to
  - Have an engaged team
  - Be informed of progress
  - Receive good-faith estimates
  - Be educated on technical and architectural factors
  - Receive suitable training and coaching

# Communicating with stakeholders - Responsibilities

- However, they also have responsibilities to
  - Remain engaged
  - Provide ongoing feedback and support
  - Define and clarify requirements
  - Collaborate with the Product Owner
  - Contribute to the growth of a trusting Agile environment

# Managing stakeholder expectations

# Managing stakeholder expectations

- Managing stakeholder expectations is critical and challenging
- Especially within an Agile context
- Balancing unlike things, features against technical investment
- Team capacity allocation can help to make this more tangible

# Negotiable scope

- A key techniques is to set expectations that have negotiable scope
  - This allows for change
  - While containing creep
  - Although not all Agile practitioners agree with such approaches
- 
- Feature set prioritisation review is a key touch-point for managing expectations

# Scaling stakeholders

# Scaling stakeholder management

- The Scaled Agile Framework (SAFe) can help to scale Agile practice
- Established and proven framework
- However, not universally popular with Agile practitioners
- The details of SAFe are outside the scope of this module
- However, useful to recognise it
  - Used in some larger organisations
  - May be required by some regulators

# Stakeholders